



Consent for Online Surveys

Study Title: Word Meanings and Descriptive Labels Study

IRBNet #: 2446127

Consent Version: 5/18/2026

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Faculty Sponsor: Krystyna Matusiak, PhD, University of Denver, Research Methods and Information Science, Morgridge College of Education

You are invited to participate in a research study. The purpose of this study is to investigate how people understand words that have more than one meaning. The study is part of research on language comprehension and the cognitive organization of word meaning.

Procedures

If you decide to participate, you will be asked to complete two online surveys that will take about 45–55 minutes (total) of your time. In the surveys, you will read a series of short sentences containing common English words. In one portion, your task is to indicate which sentences make sense grammatically and which do not by pressing the appropriate key. In another portion of the study, you will evaluate how well certain descriptive labels fit the topic of sentence pairs.

The content in these surveys is not controversial or sensitive. At the end of the surveys, you will be asked to complete a brief demographic questionnaire followed by a qualitative feedback survey. Your qualitative feedback is anonymous, will not affect your SONA credit, and is used solely for methodological refinement for future studies. Some details about what we are specifically testing will be explained after you complete the study rather than beforehand.

Your participation in this research study is voluntary, and you do not have to participate. If you decide to participate, you are free to stop at any time. You may skip questions or items if you don't want to answer them. You will receive class credit for participating in this research project. Alternative methods of earning research credit are available through other studies listed on the DU Department of Psychology Research Participation System (SONA). This study is conducted 100% online.

Risks/Discomforts and Benefits

While you may not benefit directly from this research, your responses will be used to inform how information organization and search tools are designed and evaluated, with the goal of making them more intuitive for the people who use them. Potential risks and/or discomforts of participation may include: 1) mild eye strain or visual fatigue similar to routine computer use for academic work, 2) minor physical discomfort sitting at a computer for the survey duration, 3) the repetitive nature of making grammatical judgments or ratings may cause minor boredom or frustration, similar to that experienced during standardized testing; 4) although the study is anonymous and participants are told there are "no right or wrong answers" for the rating task, some individuals may experience mild anxiety about their performance, similar to taking a quiz; and 5) the tasks require sustained attention and decision-making over 45–55 minutes, which may result in mild mental fatigue similar to completing a homework or



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reading assignment for class. These risks and/or discomforts are not expected to be any greater than anything you encounter in everyday life.

Confidentiality of Information

Before you begin, please note that the data you provide may be collected and used by Pavlovia as per its privacy agreement. Please be mindful to respond in a private setting and through a secure Internet connection for your privacy. Your confidentiality will be maintained to the degree permitted by the technology used. Specifically, no guarantees can be made regarding the interception of data sent via the Internet by any third parties.

Your name and identifying information will not be connected in any way to your responses in this study. The online system will grant you credit when you submit your responses by separately submitting your Identity Code to the Department of Psychology Research Participation System, while your responses are sent to a different database for retrieval by the researcher. Despite these measures, we cannot guarantee the anonymity of your personal data.

Future Research and Data Sharing

The anonymous response data will be retained at the discretion of the investigator and could then be used for future research studies or may be shared with the research community at large (i.e., in data repositories) to advance science. By current scientific standards and known methods, no one will be able to identify you from the information we share.

Questions

If you have additional questions, please contact the Principal Investigator, Nicholas Meister at nicholas.meister@du.edu. You can also contact the Faculty Sponsor, Dr. Krystyna Matusiak, at Krystyna.Matusiak@du.edu.

If you have any questions or concerns about your rights as a research participant, you may contact the University of Denver's Institutional Review Board (IRB) by emailing IRBAdmin@du.edu to speak to someone other than the researchers.

By clicking the link below, I confirm that I have read this form and decided that I will participate in the project described above. Its general purposes, the particulars of involvement, and possible risks and inconveniences have been explained to my satisfaction. I understand that I can discontinue participation at any time. My consent also indicates that I am at least 18 years of age. [Please feel free to print a copy of this consent form.]

☐

I agree to participate (link to survey)

☐

I decline (link to close webpage)